



AGAPAY

Stripe Account & Payouts Guide

A clear walkthrough for parish and monastery administrators to verify Stripe, manage payouts, understand deposits, and use the Parish+ Bookstore.

Verify

Complete Stripe identity and organization checks.

Deposit

Connect the parish bank account used for payouts.

Reconcile

Read balances, transactions, fees, and payout history.

Sell

Accept bookstore payments without an AGAPAY transaction fee.

Prepared for Orthodox parishes and monasteries using AGAPAY
Updated July 2026

SECTION -

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NOTE

This guide reflects AGAPAY's current Stripe Connect / Express setup and public pricing as of July 2026. Stripe, IRS, banking, and product rules can change, so AGAPAY may update this guide periodically.

SECTION 1

Understanding How AGAPAY Uses Stripe

AGAPAY uses Stripe Connect with connected Stripe accounts so each parish or monastery can receive online gifts through its own Stripe account. Stripe handles payment processing, onboarding, identity verification, and payout mechanics; AGAPAY provides the Orthodox giving platform and support layer.

Donor gives via AGAPAY	Stripe processes payment	One combined fee is applied	Net funds move toward payout
Gift submitted	Payment authorized	5% + \$0.30 total donation fee	Remainder settles to the parish

AGAPAY does not require your parish to create a separate standard Stripe account at stripe.com. Your connected account is created or linked through AGAPAY and is accessed from the AGAPAY admin portal or a secure Stripe-hosted login link.

NOTE

A Stripe Express account is different from a full Stripe Dashboard account. For most parish tasks, start inside AGAPAY and use the Manage Stripe Account or Stripe Dashboard link.

Key Concepts

Term	Plain-English Meaning
Stripe Express Account	Your parish's connected Stripe account, accessed through AGAPAY or Stripe Express.
Stripe Connect	Stripe's platform system that links AGAPAY to parish-level connected accounts.
Payout	A transfer from the Stripe balance to the parish bank account.
Pending Balance	Funds collected but not yet available for payout.
Available Balance	Funds that have cleared and are ready for payout according to the configured schedule.
Verification / KYC	Identity and organization checks required before Stripe releases funds.
AGAPAY Platform Share	The estimated 2.1% portion of the single 5% + \$0.30 donation fee. It is not an additional fee.

SECTION 2

Accessing Your Stripe Express Dashboard

Your Stripe Express dashboard is where you review account status, bank details, payout history, transaction activity, and verification alerts.

How to Access Your Dashboard

- 1 Log in to your AGAPAY Admin Portal
Visit agapay.app and sign in with your parish administrator credentials.
- 2 Open Payments or Settings
In your AGAPAY dashboard, look for the Payments or Settings section.
- 3 Choose Manage Stripe Account
Open the link labeled Manage Stripe Account, Stripe Dashboard, or similar. Stripe may open in a new tab.
- 4 Use the secure link when prompted
Stripe may ask you to confirm by email or text. Do not share dashboard links or login credentials with unauthorized users.

IMPORTANT

Treat AGAPAY administrator access as financial access. Use a dedicated parish administrator account, a strong password, and two-factor authentication wherever available.

What You May See in Stripe Express

Dashboard Area	What It Shows
Home / Overview	Current balance, recent payouts, and any actions needed.
Balances or Earnings	Pending funds, available funds, and recent activity.
Payouts	Deposits sent to the parish bank account, with dates and amounts.
Transactions	Individual gifts and qualifying payment activity processed through the parish account.
Account Settings	Organization details, representative information, bank details, and verification status.

SECTION 3

Completing Identity Verification

Before Stripe can release funds, Stripe must verify the parish or monastery and the authorized person acting as the account representative. This is a standard financial-platform requirement and applies even when the organization is a church or monastery.

IMPORTANT

Do not wait to complete verification. Donations may process while information is incomplete, but payouts can be delayed or paused until Stripe accepts the required information.

Information to Have Ready

Parish / Organization	Authorized Representative
Legal name of the parish or monastery	Full legal name
EIN / Tax ID	Date of birth
Physical mailing address	Home address
Phone number and email	Email and phone number
Parish website or AGAPAY page	Last four digits of SSN, or more if Stripe requires it
Actual legal entity or organization type	Government ID or other document if requested

Step-by-Step Verification

- 1** Open Stripe Express
 Use the AGAPAY admin portal to open the connected Stripe Express dashboard.
- 2** Look for alerts
 Stripe usually shows a banner such as Complete your account setup or Verify information when action is required.
- 3** Enter organization information
 Use the parish legal name and EIN exactly as they appear in official records.
- 4** Enter representative information
 Use an authorized person such as the treasurer, council president, or priest, depending on parish governance.

SECTION 3 continued

Completing Identity Verification

- 1** Upload documents if requested
Upload a clear image or PDF. Blurry, cropped, or expired documents often cause delays.
- 2** Submit and monitor status
Stripe review can be quick, but additional review may take longer. Return to the dashboard if Stripe requests updated information.
- 3** Tell AGAPAY if you get stuck
AGAPAY can often help identify what Stripe is requesting and guide you through the next step.

NOTE

The account representative does not have to be the priest unless the parish chooses that arrangement. Select an authorized parish officer who can respond promptly to verification requests.

Accuracy Checklist

- The legal name matches parish and IRS records.
- The EIN is entered correctly.
- The representative's name, address, date of birth, and SSN information are accurate.
- The bank account is a legitimate parish account, not a personal account.
- All Stripe alerts are resolved before relying on automatic payouts.

SECTION 4

Adding & Managing Your Bank Account

After the parish account is connected, Stripe needs the bank account where payouts should be deposited. AGAPAY currently supports U.S. bank accounts for U.S. parishes and monasteries.

Adding Your Bank Account

- 1** Open Stripe Express
Access the dashboard through the AGAPAY admin portal.
- 2** Go to Account Settings
Look for Account, Settings, Bank Accounts, External Accounts, or Payout Details.
- 3** Add the bank account
Enter the parish routing number and account number carefully. Use a parish account, not a personal account.
- 4** Choose the account type
Most parishes should use a dedicated checking account. Use savings only if that is truly the parish payout account.
- 5** Complete verification if required
Stripe may verify instantly or require microdeposits. Follow the instructions in Stripe Express.

TIP

Confirm the routing number and account number with the treasurer, bank portal, or official bank records before entering them.

Where to Find Bank Details

Where to Look	Routing Number	Account Number
Paper check	Bottom-left, usually 9 digits	Usually middle-bottom; length varies
Online banking portal	Account details or routing information	Account details or account information
Bank mobile app	Account details, routing info, or view details	Account details, account info, or view details
Call the bank	Ask for the ACH routing number	Ask for the checking / DDA account number

SECTION 4 continued

Adding & Managing Your Bank Account

Changing Your Bank Account

If your parish changes banks or opens a new operating account, update Stripe before closing the old account. Add the new account in Stripe Express, confirm it works, and remove the old payout destination only after successful payout activity.

IMPORTANT

If a parish closes its bank account before updating Stripe, payouts may fail and funds may be held while the issue is corrected. Contact AGAPAY support immediately if this happens.

Practical Controls for Parish Stewardship

- Limit dashboard and bank-editing access to authorized financial officers.
- Keep written parish records showing who is authorized to update payout information.
- Review payout deposits against AGAPAY and Stripe records at least monthly.
- Immediately investigate any payout that does not match your records.

SECTION 5

Understanding Your Payout Schedule

Stripe does not send each donation to the bank immediately. Donations first move through Stripe's balance system. Once funds become available, Stripe sends payouts according to the configured payout schedule and Stripe's risk and compliance requirements.

Common Schedule Options

Schedule Type	How It Works	Practical Use
Daily	Available funds are paid out on business days according to Stripe timing.	Faster access to funds.
Weekly	Available funds accumulate and are deposited once per week.	Fewer bank deposits to reconcile.
Monthly	Available funds accumulate and are deposited once per month.	May fit a monthly bookkeeping cycle.
Manual	Funds remain in Stripe until a manual payout is triggered.	Use only for a specific accounting reason.

Timing Expectations

Payout timing varies by payment method, account history, Stripe review, banking holidays, and bank processing. New accounts may experience longer initial payout timing. Once available, bank arrival commonly takes one or more business days, depending on the bank.

Changing the Schedule

- 1 Open Stripe Express
Access through the AGAPAY admin portal.
- 2 Find payout settings
Look for Bank Accounts, Payout Details, or Payout Schedule.
- 3 Choose an available frequency
Select the option that best fits parish cash flow and reconciliation.
- 4 Contact AGAPAY if controls are not shown
The platform may control payout scheduling. AGAPAY can assist when Stripe Express does not expose the setting.

TIP

Daily payouts generally provide faster access to funds. Weekly payouts may be easier when the treasurer prefers fewer bank deposits to reconcile.

SECTION 6

Reading Your Balance & Transaction History

Stripe Express gives your parish a working view of donation activity, balances, fees, and bank payouts. Exact labels can vary as Stripe updates its dashboard.

Understanding Balances

Balance Type	What It Means	What Happens Next
Pending	Donations received but not yet available for payout.	Moves to available after Stripe clearance and any review period.
Available	Funds cleared and ready to be paid out.	Included in a payout according to the configured schedule.
In Transit	Funds already sent from Stripe but not yet posted by the bank.	Arrives when the bank completes processing.

Viewing Transactions

Open Transactions or Activity to see individual donations. Depending on the available Stripe reporting view, a transaction may show the date, gross amount, total fee, payment method, net amount, and transaction ID. AGAPAY reporting may provide the clearest breakdown between the Stripe processing portion and the AGAPAY platform share.

NOTE

Export transaction history as a CSV when available. This is helpful for bookkeeping, annual donor statements, and audit trails.

Viewing Payout History

Open Payouts to see deposits sent to the parish bank account. Each payout should show the amount, initiation date, expected arrival date, and included transactions. Reconcile payouts against bank deposits and parish giving records.

SECTION 7

Handling Common Issues

Payouts Are Not Arriving

- Confirm the bank account is entered correctly and verified.
- Check whether funds are still pending or under review.
- Look for Stripe dashboard alerts requiring information.
- Confirm identity verification is complete.
- Contact AGAPAY if the delay continues beyond the expected payout window.

Stripe Requests More Information

- Open Stripe Express and read the alert carefully.
- Provide the specific document or correction requested.
- Make sure the parish legal name and EIN match official records.
- Respond promptly; unresolved requests can pause payouts.
- Ask AGAPAY for help if the request is unclear.

Refunds or Disputes

- Refunds and disputes may reduce the available balance.
- If the balance becomes negative, Stripe may offset a future payout.
- Contact AGAPAY promptly if you receive a dispute notice.
- Keep donor communications and giving records for parish bookkeeping.

Bank Account Rejected

- Re-check routing and account numbers.
- Confirm the account is open, active, and in the parish's name.
- Ask the bank whether ACH deposits are enabled.
- Re-enter the bank account or contact AGAPAY support.

SECTION 8

Donation Fees & What Gets Deposited

AGAPAY uses one combined donation transaction fee of 5% + \$0.30. This total includes Stripe's estimated standard online card-processing cost and AGAPAY's platform share. The two portions are not added together a second time.

How the Total Donation Fee Is Divided

Fee Component	Typical Amount	Who Receives It
Stripe processing portion	Estimated 2.9% + \$0.30 for a standard domestic online card transaction	Stripe
AGAPAY platform portion	Estimated 2.1%	AGAPAY
Total donation transaction fee	5% + \$0.30	Combined total
Net to parish	Donation minus the single combined fee	Deposited to parish bank account

Correct Example Calculations

	\$25 Donation	\$100 Donation	\$250 Donation
Donor gives	\$25.00	\$100.00	\$250.00
Total fee (5% + \$0.30)	-\$1.55	-\$5.30	-\$12.80
Approx. Stripe portion	-\$1.03	-\$3.20	-\$7.55
Approx. AGAPAY portion	-\$0.52	-\$2.10	-\$5.25
Net to parish	\$23.45	\$94.70	\$237.20

IMPORTANT AGAPAY's 2.1% platform share is part of the advertised 5% + \$0.30 total fee. It is not an additional charge on top of that total.

Monthly Plans

Monthly subscription pricing is separate from donation transaction fees. Current standard tiers include Mission at \$49/month, Parish at \$99/month, Monastic at \$0/month, and custom pricing for cathedrals and dioceses. Special agreements control when applicable.

Tax Reporting

Depending on AGAPAY's Stripe Connect configuration and applicable law, Stripe or AGAPAY may make tax information forms available when required. Forms report gross processed payments and do not determine whether funds are taxable. Federal and state rules can change; parishes should consult their accountant or tax adviser.

SECTION 9

AGAPAY Parish+ Bookstore

AGAPAY Parish+ adds parish commerce tools alongside AGAPAY Give. The current live commerce tool is Bookstore, designed for books, prayer ropes, icons, candles, and other parish goods. Bookstore sales remain separate from donations and stewardship gifts.

PRICING

Parish+ costs \$39 per month. AGAPAY takes no transaction fee on commerce sales. Standard Stripe payment-processing fees still apply.

What Bookstore Does

Feature	How It Helps
My AGAPAY checkout	Parishioners purchase parish goods from their unified My AGAPAY account.
Product catalog	List books, prayer ropes, icons, candles, and other approved parish goods.
Order tracking	Keep purchase and fulfillment records separate from donation records.
Simple inventory visibility	See available products and support basic stock awareness.
Sales tax support	Calculate applicable sales tax during checkout based on configured settings.
Barcode-assisted entry	Use a book barcode to help fill title and author information when supported.
Direct settlement	Commerce funds settle through the parish's connected Stripe account.

Important Separation

- A bookstore purchase is commerce, not a charitable donation.
- Commerce receipts should not be treated as charitable-giving statements.
- Sales, refunds, taxes, and inventory records should remain distinct from stewardship and designated-fund reporting.
- The parish remains responsible for product descriptions, fulfillment, returns, and applicable tax obligations.

SECTION 10

Commerce Fees & Reconciliation

The fee model for Parish+ Bookstore is intentionally different from AGAPAY Give. AGAPAY charges the monthly Parish+ subscription, but does not take a percentage or fixed fee from commerce transactions.

Commerce Fee Breakdown

Commerce Cost	Amount	Notes
AGAPAY commerce transaction fee	\$0	AGAPAY does not take a per-sale fee.
Parish+ subscription	\$39/month	Monthly add-on for the current Bookstore commerce tool.
Stripe processing fee	Stripe's applicable processing rate	Deducted by Stripe based on the payment method and transaction.
Sales tax	Amount collected from purchaser when applicable	Held and remitted according to the parish's tax obligations.
Net commerce proceeds	Sale amount minus Stripe fees, refunds, and applicable adjustments	Settles to the parish through Stripe.

Illustrative Commerce Example

Example: \$25 Book Sale	Amount
Customer pays	\$25.00 plus any applicable sales tax
AGAPAY transaction fee	\$0.00
Stripe processing fee	Varies under the parish's Stripe pricing and payment method
Net to parish	Purchase amount and collected tax, less Stripe processing and any adjustments

NOTE

Do not use the 5% + \$0.30 donation fee when reconciling Bookstore sales. That fee applies to AGAPAY Give donations, not Parish+ commerce transactions.

Recommended Reconciliation Workflow

- 1 Separate sales from gifts
Use distinct Bookstore and Giving reports.
- 2 Match orders to Stripe activity
Confirm each order amount, tax, refund, and Stripe fee.
- 3 Reconcile payouts
A single Stripe payout may contain multiple eligible transactions; use transaction-level detail when available.
- 4 Review tax totals
Track taxes collected separately from product revenue.
- 5 Retain records
Keep order, refund, payout, and tax records according to parish policy and applicable law.

SECTION 11

Contacting Support

AGAPAY is the first stop for most questions about the giving platform, Stripe Express access, verification, payouts, donation fees, Bookstore sales, Parish+ billing, and reconciliation.

AGAPAY Support

How to Reach Us	Details
Website	agapay.app
Issue Types	Stripe Express access, payouts, verification, fees, transaction questions, Parish+ Bookstore, and platform support
Response Time	AGAPAY aims to respond promptly during normal support hours.
Helpful Information	Transaction ID, payout ID, order number, date, amount, parish name, and screenshots of any Stripe alert

Contacting Stripe Directly

Some issues can be handled inside Stripe Express using its Help or Support links. However, because AGAPAY operates the platform relationship and product workflows, AGAPAY should usually be contacted first.

TIP

For a specific donation, sale, refund, or payout, include the date, amount, transaction ID or order number, and a screenshot of any dashboard alert.



AGAPAY

Thank you for being part of AGAPAY. Clear giving, responsible commerce, and faithful stewardship help strengthen Orthodox parish life.

Love how you give.